



PlayStation+ for PS4

Sony has detailed the changes made to its premium service on PSN which will reflect on the PS4 <http://dgit.in/16DFGXU>



Interactive iOS 7 Demo

Don't have an iPhone and want to try iOS 7? Do not worry, try this interactive demo to get the iOS 7 experience on the web <http://dgit.in/19PYZB6>

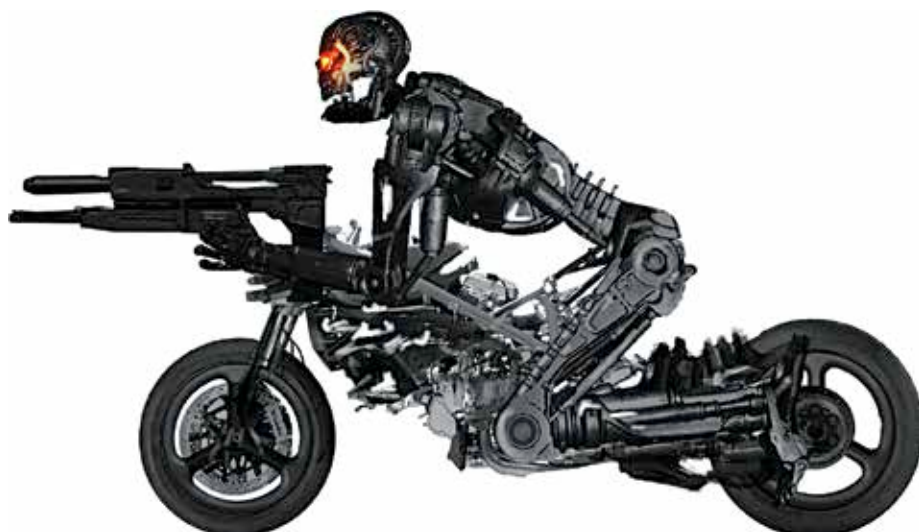
Feature

THE FATHER OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE: WOULD HE BE PROUD?

The term Artificial Intelligence was coined by John McCarthy, so it is safe to consider him to be the father of Artificial Intelligence. One look at the man's career, and you realize that he contributed enormously to what understanding we have today of the problem at hand. Having studied under John Von Neumann himself, he began his inspired journey with Mathematical Logic as his area of expertise. He realized the great potential of the field, and kicked off one of the greatest grail hunts of the computing era – that of a machine which could act like

a human. In the process, he worked on the MIT MSC Lab, started the Stanford AI Lab, developed the most respected (and simultaneously most feared) family of computer languages – Lisp. Add to his work on general language features such as garbage collection and Lambda Calculus, and factor in his work on actual AI chess players, advice takers, in addition to his contribution to the computing principle of time sharing of resources (and a lot, lot more, including some literary work involving AI), you can be sure that this is one father who casts a really, really long shadow. By comparison, we have only moved a paltry few steps on our own.

accurate. This is the policy that is followed by Machine Learning, where the system continually tracks a particular metric, and essentially tests its hypothesis against the practical inputs, and tries to improve the accuracy of future predictions. And of course, the medium for doing that would have to be natural language, for which Natural Language processing is deployed, so that the translation from human script to computer script carries all the meaning of the original instruction.



"We just hope we're long gone before the robots (inevitably) turn into killer savages"

CRITICISMS OF THE TURING TEST

It is claimed that the Turing Test cannot be said to be a true test of a thinking machine because the test can be passed by clever modifications of the input and thereby bypassing actual 'thinking' tasks. An example for such an approach are the common AI bots such as ELIZA and PARRY, among others. The general workflow for these programs is to parse the input given by the user, search for particular keywords, and respond with either transforms of the input sentence, or stored responses.

This results in a situation where the computer does not actually understand anything that is being conveyed by the user, but because of the reader's understanding bias, it is assumed that the responses were meant for the given situation, and the contextual meaning is applied. Therefore, it is claimed that even at such a mature stage, most AI practices are based on clever wordplays rather than any real clever programming.

What we'd like to do

Well, basically, the task to install the sense of context into machines. It should not have to be hunting for keywords at all, but learn to match abstracts as well as it manages to match data. This is the real advantage that humans have over computers. We can have thoughts of our own – we can have opinions based on our own philosophy, and move forward with what we consider to be our own free will (although we have covered previously how that might not be true at all). Now, just a quick background check to give you some perspective, in previous issues, we had theorized that a.) the universe might be a computer simulation, and b.) that the human brain is a very powerful supercomputer. Now, we're trying to create computers that can mimic humans. Can it get any more meta than that?

What would the dog do when it catches the car?

Well, fortunately, we humans are a very imaginative bunch. Although saying that we've not made as spectacular a dent in Artificial Intelligence as we have in most other fields that we've laid hands on is true, that in no way belittles the contributions of the brilliant minds working on it – this is simply an evidence of how hard it really is to do so. But that does not mean that we haven't planned for when we get there. Aside from all the fantastic model plans from Hollywood, there are some very real applications of having a humanoid presence in places where humans wouldn't go. But above all, there would be real-live R2-D2s and C-3POs. Amen (and simultaneous cheers) to that.